ABUBAKAR TOWFIQ

Senior QA Engineer (SDET) | Playwright | Test Automation | TypeScript | React | API Testing | CI/CD
Lausanne,Switzerland | +4179 368 05 70 | zubeir.abubakar525@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/abubakar-towfiq
Permit B residency

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior QA Engineer (SDET) with 6+ years of experience delivering quality across SaaS and fintech platforms. Skilled in Playwright, Cypress, Selenium, TypeScript, API testing, CI/CD, and performance testing. Built scalable automation frameworks, integrated automated tests into CI/CD pipelines, reduced regression time by 40%, and led shift-left QA initiatives. ISTQB Certified with experience in web, mobile, and distributed systems, focused on delivering reliable, production-ready software.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Test Automation: Playwright, Selenium WebDriver, Cypress, Appium

API Testing: Postman, REST APIs, Swagger/OpenAPI, Kafka, Event-Driven Systems

CI/CD: Jenkins, Azure DevOps, GitLab CI, Docker, Git, GitHub

Programming: TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, Java, SQL,Elixir

Observability & Monitoring: Grafana, Logging & Monitoring Systems

Quality Engineering and testing: End-to-End ,Component , Regression , Smoke , Integration ,Cross-browser, Cross-device , Exploratory , Release Validation

Performance: JMeter, k6

Test Management: Jira, Xray, TestRail, Linear , Notion

Methodologies: Agile, Scrum, BDD, SDLC, DevOps, SRE, Shift-Left Testing

AI in QA: AI-Powered Test Generation, Defect Analysis, Regression Optimization

Domains: Fintech, SaaS, Distributed Systems

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead QA Engineer *Oct 2023 – April 2026*

Cashia ***Nairobi, Kenya***

- Owned end-to-end software quality across web applications serving multiple international markets.
- Built and maintained scalable Playwright, Cypress and Selenium automation frameworks.
- Designed comprehensive regression suites covering critical customer workflows.
- Integrated automated tests into CI/CD pipelines enabling continuous quality validation.
- Defined QA strategy, release readiness criteria and regression gates.
- Led functional, integration, API, regression and performance testing.
- Partnered closely with developers during feature refinement using shift-left quality practices.
- Built automated API validation for distributed microservices.
- Improved regression execution time by approximately 40%.
- Established defect triage practices, severity classification and quality metrics.
- Performed cross-browser compatibility testing.

- Used Grafana monitoring to validate production health and reduce incidents.
- Mentored QA engineers and promoted automation-first quality culture.
- Achieved zero critical production escapes across major releases.

QA Engineer *Mar 2021 – Oct 2023*
Cashia , *Nairobi, Kenya*
(Promoted to Lead QA Engineer - see above)

- Built regression, integration, and smoke test suites for web and mobile applications
- Performed API testing across 200+ endpoints validating authentication and business logic
- Designed and maintained automated test cases improving release confidence
- Conducted performance testing using JMeter under high-load scenarios
- Collaborated with developers to identify defects early and improve SDLC quality

QA Engineer (Contract) Feb 2024 – May 2024
Nobilis ***Nairobi, Kenya***

- Performed testing activities for ERP and financial systems within a regulated Swiss enterprise environment.
- Executed functional, integration, API, and database testing to ensure accuracy and compliance of business-critical systems.
- Conducted SQL database validation and backend data verification to ensure reporting accuracy and system consistency.
- Automated regression scenarios using Selenium and Python to improve testing efficiency and coverage.
- Collaborated with project teams within agile workflows, supporting release readiness and quality assurance activities.

Junior Backend Developer Sep 2019 – Mar 2020
Safaricom PLC Nairobi, Kenya

- Developed backend features and wrote automated unit and integration tests using Python and JavaScript, building a foundation in quality engineering practices.
- Collaborated with QA engineers on system validation and user acceptance testing (UAT) for telecom-scale distributed systems.

CERTIFICATIONS

• ISTQB Certified Tester - Foundation Level
• Certified Lead QA Engineer - Micro1
• Certified Senior QA Engineer (CSQE) - Alison
• Coding Fundamentals - Grasshopper (Google)

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree, Software Engineering 2019
Moringa School of Technology, Nairobi, Kenya

LANGUAGES

English (C2) | French (B2) | Swahili (Native) | Somali (Native)